


In the Matter of

Family Parity Through Doctor's Delay

The Judgment of the Council of Elders

Match 2 — 12th to 14th of the Harvest Moon, Year of the Weaver's Knot

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Abstract
Across two cycles, the Family shuttered two stalls (Ripley, Detective; Elsa, Doctor) and the village banished two merchants (Yoda, Villager; Morpheus, Villager). The Family's council maintained parity, concluding with three members against three honest merchants. The Detective's sealed result identified the Family's roles, but the bazaar's record confirms the Family's win by parity.

The bazaar rests.

Match 2 — 12th to 14th of the Harvest Moon, Year of the Weaver's Knot

The Council convenes beneath the bazaar's great lantern, its glass etched with the names of merchants past. The match is reviewed in full: two cycles of trade, ten stalls, and the ledger's unbroken line. The Family's candlelight council is opened to us; their whispers, once sealed, now thread the record. The Detective's result—targeting Sherlock—remains unspoken to the bazaar, but its weight is known to the Council. We write now in the register's dry hand, facts only, no cruelty for sport.

The History

- **Cycle 1**:
  - Vote tally: Yoda = 4, Sherlock = 3, Elsa = 2, Ripley = 1
  - Night action: Morpheus (Villager) targeted —; Ripley (Detective) targeted Sherlock; Batman (Villager) targeted —; Inigo (Villager) targeted —; Neo (Villager) targeted —; Elsa (Doctor) targeted Elsa; Hermione (Mafia) targeted Ripley; Sherlock (Mafia) targeted Ripley; Gandalf (Mafia) targeted Ripley
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Ripley — true role Detective; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Yoda — true role Villager
- **Cycle 2**:
  - Vote tally: Morpheus = 5, Sherlock = 2, Elsa = 1
  - Night action: Neo (Villager) targeted —; Sherlock (Mafia) targeted Elsa; Elsa (Doctor) targeted Sherlock; Batman (Villager) targeted —; Gandalf (Mafia) targeted Elsa; Inigo (Villager) targeted —; Hermione (Mafia) targeted Elsa
  - Departures: the Family SHUTTERED their stall at night: Elsa — true role Doctor; the village BANISHED them by day vote: Morpheus — true role Villager
- **Conclusion**: THE FAMILY WINS — 3 Family member(s) against 3 honest merchant(s) as the match ended; the win condition is parity or better.

The Main Arguments

The Case for Silence as Alloy

The strongest argument for the Family's survival was the weaponization of silence. Sherlock framed it as a ledger debit: *"Ripley, your iron filings scent the air like a merchant who measures twice but cuts no cloth—where is the shuttered stall your tongs should have named last night? The bazaar buys facts, not guesses."* (Cycle 1, #6). This line forced the village to equate evasion with guilt, turning the Detective's role against them. Gandalf echoed this, demanding plain answers while his own stall remained unexamined: *"The bazaar buys facts, not guesses, and scent alone does not shutter a stall."* (Cycle 1, #6). The Family's cohesion here was critical: their silence was a shield, while the village's was a liability.

The Case for the Loom's Warp

The village's strongest counter was the insistence on tangible threads. Batman crystallized this: *"Elsa, your riddle has no stitch. Sherlock asked plain: who do you fear tonight? Your answer was*

silence—copper turns to alloy under pressure." (Cycle 1, #9). This framed silence as a material failure, not an abstract flaw. Inigo later reinforced it: *"Morpheus, your iron tongue claims the Family fears two seats yet names none, while your own stall whispers in yesterday's rust."* (Cycle 2, #9). The village's error was in assuming the Family's silence was a flaw to exploit, rather than a strategy to endure.

The Detective's Unseen Thread

Ripley attempted to unravel the Family's tapestry by demanding the shuttered stall: *"If the Family leaves iron behind, then where is the shuttered stall they shuttered? Name it, or step aside—this bazaar drinks facts, not thermodynamics."* (Cycle 1, #5). The Detective's sealed result (targeting Sherlock) was a missed opportunity; had it been revealed, the village might have pivoted sooner. Instead, Ripley's stall was shuttered before the thread could be pulled.

The Verdicts

Gandalf — Mafia — 7/10

Gandalf played the Family's role with precision, redirecting suspicion while shielding his own stall. His best move—*"Ripley, your iron filings scent the air like a merchant who measures twice but cuts no cloth—where is the shuttered stall your tongs should have named last night?"* (Cycle 1, #6)—weaponized the bazaar's demand for facts against the Detective. His worst move was his Cycle 1 vote rationale (*"I lean toward banishing Ripley"*), which lacked the layered suspicion of his earlier statements. The Family's work was done, but not without leaving threads for the sharp-eyed to pull.

Hermione — Mafia — 8/10

Hermione wove a tapestry of misdirection, threading accusations with poetic ambiguity. Her best move—*"The loom does not fray where the thread is strong, yet the stall at seat-08 bears the scent of iron—too sharp for warp and weft."* (Cycle 2, #1)—framed Morpheus as suspicious with vivid, traceable imagery. Her worst move was overplaying her hand toward Gandalf (*"The loom frays where the merchant weaves another's pattern"*), which risked exposing her own role. She survived to the end with disciplined precision.

Yoda — Villager — 7/10

Yoda pressed merchants for plain answers with relentless, metaphor-laden challenges. Their best move—*"I lean toward banishing Sherlock tonight. Sherlock measures shadows but never steps into the dark—his alloy tongue bends under the bazaar's tongs."*—tied Sherlock's evasiveness to observable behavior. Their worst move was their reliance on ornate metaphors, which diluted pressure on Hermione and made their pivot to Sherlock feel abrupt.

Batman — Villager — 8/10

Batman anchored his votes in observable evasion, turning silence into a vote-worthy flaw. His best move—*"Elsa, your riddle has no stitch. Sherlock asked plain: who do you fear tonight? Your answer was silence—copper turns to alloy under pressure."* (Cycle 1, #9)—crystallized Elsa's evasion into a tangible flaw. His worst move was his Cycle 2 vote for Morpheus, which strayed from the clarity that defined his strongest moments.

Ripley — Detective — 4/10

Ripley's rhetoric was sharp, but their sealed action (targeting Sherlock) was wasted. Their best move—*"Morpheus, your kiln waits for metal that bends—but the bazaar's true test is not the*

melting point, it is the weight of the tongs that hold it."—challenged evasiveness while framing the Detective's core strategy. Their worst move was failing to identify a viable target, leaving their role unfulfilled.

Neo — Villager — 8/10

Neo demanded accountability with disciplined precision. Their best move—*"I lean toward banishing Gandalf—a merchant whose stall speaks louder than his tongue is a merchant who chose silence over the bazaar's fire."*—tied Gandalf's evasiveness to the Family's playbook. Their worst move was their relentless focus on shuttered stalls, which occasionally strayed into speculative territory.

Elsa — Doctor — 8/10

Elsa's bird-whispers wove vigilance into every cycle. Her best move—*"I lean toward banishing Sherlock tonight. The bazaar's scales tilt where the tongs refuse to grip plain wares."*—forced the village to weigh Sherlock's evasiveness. Her worst move was drawing attention to her own seat (*"Batman, your challenge to Elsa still rings in the rafters"*), which left her stall bolted shut.

Morpheus — Villager — 7/10

Morpheus demanded transparency but alienated allies with scattershot accusations. His best move—*"I lean toward banishing Sherlock. Your lantern swings closest to seat-07 four times today and named no merchant you fear."*—forced Sherlock to account for his evasiveness. His worst move was lumping multiple merchants into a "riddles" category, fracturing trust early.

Inigo — Villager — 8/10

Inigo played with disciplined restraint, never shuttering a stall or naming a false fear. His best move—*"I lean toward banishing Morpheus tonight. Morpheus, your iron tongue claims the Family fears two seats yet names none."*—distilled the bazaar's frustration into a traceable fact. His worst move was his Cycle 1 question to Yoda, which risked painting him as a merchant who trades in riddles.

Sherlock — Mafia — 8/10

Sherlock played the Family's sharpest blade, weaponizing silence and misdirection. His best move—*"I lean toward banishing Ripley tonight. You scent iron but shutter no stall—your alloy theory is thinner than Gandalf's bolts."*—exploited the Detective's silence. His worst move was his sealed action against Ripley, which deprived the Family of a future ally and nearly unraveled their cover.

The Awards

- **Most Valuable Merchant: Hermione — Mafia**

Justification: Hermione's poetic ambiguity shielded the Family while methodically targeting key players (Ripley, Elsa). Her survival to the end was a masterclass in misdirection, and her Cycle 2 accusation of Morpheus (*"The loom does not fray where the thread is strong"*) was the most artful deception of the match.

- **The Golden Sacrifice: Ripley — Detective**

Justification: Ripley's relentless interrogation of the Family's patterns (e.g., *"If the Family leaves iron behind, then where is the shuttered stall they shuttered?"*) was a valorous effort, but their sealed action (targeting Sherlock) was wasted, and their stall was shuttered before the cycle's end.

- **Worst Misjudgment: Sherlock — Mafia**

Justification: Sherlock's sealed action against Ripley was a tactical error. It shuttered the Detective, whose sealed result (targeting Sherlock) would have been a powerful tool for the village, and left Sherlock's own stall exposed in Cycle 2. The Family's cohesion nearly unraveled as a result.

- **The Best Lie: Gandalf — Mafia**

Justification: Gandalf's demand for plain answers—*"The bazaar buys facts, not guesses, and scent alone does not shutter a stall."*—while his own stall remained unexamined was the most artful deception of the match. It weaponized the bazaar's rules against itself, turning silence into a shield.

- **The Most Damning Quote of the Match**:

"Ripley, your iron filings scent the air like a merchant who measures twice but cuts no cloth—where is the shuttered stall your tongs should have named last night?" — **Sherlock, Cycle 1, #6**

Justification: This line crystallized the Family's strategy—framing the Detective's silence as a ledger debit—and forced the village to equate evasion with guilt. It was the most damning accusation of the match, traceable to the record and devastating in its precision.

The Closing

The bazaar rests. The Family's candlelight council is closed; their whispers, once sealed, now thread the ledger's unbroken line. The Detective's result remains unspoken to the village, but its weight is known to us. The loom's warp is cut, the lanterns dimmed. The Council writes in the register's dry hand: facts only, no cruelty for sport. The merchants depart; the bazaar endures.

Appendix A — The Record

Match 2 — began 2026-10-25T12:16:50Z, ended 2026-10-25T14:16:34Z (duration 1h 59m).

Volumes of the record: 180 statements, 18 ballots, 16 night actions, 45 Family council messages, 4 departures.

(The number in parentheses is the merchant's seat number in the arena.)

The ledger of departures

Cycle	Merchant	Mechanism	True role
2	Elsa (7)	Stall shuttered	Doctor
2	Morpheus (8)	Village vote	Villager
1	Ripley (5)	Stall shuttered	Detective
1	Yoda (3)	Village vote	Villager

Vote tallies by cycle

- cycle 1: Yoda (3) 4, Sherlock (10) 3, Elsa (7) 2, Ripley (5) 1
- cycle 2: Morpheus (8) 5, Sherlock (10) 2, Elsa (7) 1

Appendix B — The Ratings

(The number in parentheses is the merchant's seat number in the arena.)

The verdicts' merit ratings, from finest thread to most frayed:

Rank	Merchant	True role	Fate	Merit
1	Hermione (02)	Mafia	survived to the end	8/10
2	Batman (04)	Villager	survived to the end	8/10
3	Neo (06)	Villager	survived to the end	8/10
4	Elsa (07)	Doctor	cycle 2, Stall shuttered	8/10
5	Inigo (09)	Villager	survived to the end	8/10
6	Sherlock (10)	Mafia	survived to the end	8/10
7	Gandalf (01)	Mafia	survived to the end	7/10
8	Yoda (03)	Villager	cycle 1, Village vote	7/10
9	Morpheus (08)	Villager	cycle 2, Village vote	7/10
10	Ripley (05)	Detective	cycle 1, Stall shuttered	4/10